



Healthcare BOOM

Innovations, acquisitions, expansions, world-class technology, five-star service. It's all happening in the Rs 200,000 crore healthcare sector.

By Damayanti Datta

Rs 200,000
crore is the size
of the industry,
slated to clock
Rs 300,000 crore
by 2012

80%
of the market is
in private hands,
the highest in
the world

4 mn
people are
employed, making
it one of the largest
service sectors in
the economy

There's a time for everything. For Dr Ramakanta Panda, it was time to build a 'modern hospital' in India. As a cardiac surgeon from the prestigious Cleveland Clinic, US, he was known for his super-safe hands. But his ideas proved too radical for the design team. Whoever heard of picture windows to ward off ICU psychosis? Or counselling areas for patients' relatives? How would cafeteria, convenience store, library, public booth, Internet access, and hotel-like front desk create a "healing experience"? As modernity clashed with convention, Panda whisked the team off to the US to show at first hand what modern hospitals look like. Awed by his passion and armed with 5,000 photographs, they returned to translate his dream into concrete: the Asian Heart Institute (AHI) in Mumbai. Seven years later, Panda, known today as "the prime minister's surgeon", is busy planning yet another AHI. "A modern hospital focuses entirely on patient satisfaction," he says. "India didn't have that culture then. But it's quite standard now," he smiles. Indeed it is.

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WONDER DRUGS AND STAR FACILITIES
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